# The Hygiene Trap

Blinded water swap: protocol and diary

A test of whether breath, or how you feel, **follows the fridge water**. It is a plan for one person with a helper. It is not validated, and a statistician should check it. **Do not do this if you have a weak immune system. See a dentist first** to rule out the ordinary causes of bad breath (a coated tongue, gum disease, cavities). Stop and see a doctor if you feel worse.

### What you need

- A helper who is not you, and who will keep the key sealed until the end.
- A handheld breath sulphide meter, used the same way every day. Two sets of identical opaque or lettered bottles, **A** and **B**.
- For each week, the helper fills the bottles with either water from the fridge dispenser (first draw, as you would normally drink it) or clean cold tap water from a jug, and tells you only "A" or "B".

### The design

1. **Six pairs of weeks.** In each pair the helper flips a coin to decide which of A or B is the fridge water in week 1 and which in week 2, and records it on the key below. Six pairs are the fewest for which all six going the same way gives a chance result of about 3 in 100.
2. All your plain drinking water that week comes from the coded bottles. Other drinks as usual.
3. Take the meter reading each morning **before** eating, drinking or brushing, at the same time within half an hour. Note anything unusual (garlic, alcohol, illness, antibiotics).
4. Score bad breath, bad taste and gut symptoms from 0 to 3 each evening: 0 none, 1 mild, 2 noticeable, 3 strong.
5. At the end of each week, **guess** whether it was A or B, and how sure you are. If you guess right far more than half the time, the blinding failed.

**Decide the rule before you start** (our suggestion: use days 3 to 7 of each week, and call it a match only if all six pairs go the same way, higher on fridge water). Write your own here and sign it with the date.

_____

_____ Date _____

**Helper's key: keep sealed until the end**

| Pair | Week 1: A or B is the fridge water | Week 2 |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | | |
| 2 | | |
| 3 | | |
| 4 | | |
| 5 | | |
| 6 | | |

### Weekly diary (copy this page for each of the 12 weeks)

Pair _____ Week 1 / 2  Bottles: A / B  Week starting _____

| Day | Date | Meter reading (morning) | Bad breath 0-3 | Bad taste 0-3 | Gut 0-3 | Anything unusual |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 (settling) | | | | | | |
| 2 (settling) | | | | | | |
| 3 | | | | | | |
| 4 | | | | | | |
| 5 | | | | | | |
| 6 | | | | | | |
| 7 | | | | | | |

End of the week: my guess ☐ A ☐ B  How sure: ☐ 1 guess ☐ 2 fairly ☐ 3 very

Days 1 and 2 are a settling period, our suggestion, not a validated washout. Record them, but analyse days 3 to 7. Unblind only after all twelve weeks are done and the table has been filled in.

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**Source:** The Hygiene Trap, print pages. https://fridge-water.ownhealth.bio/fridge-water#handouts (whole site: https://fridge-water.ownhealth.bio/). Printed November 6, 2026.
Every claim carries a label: established, plausible, untested, anecdote or real. This is a hypothesis, not a diagnosis: for persistent bad breath or symptoms, see a dentist and a doctor.
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